

KORE.AI COMPETITIVE INTELLIGENCE

Competitive Signal Report

Topic: Enterprise agentic AI & contact-center AI (CCAI) · Window: last 72h · Thursday, 23 July 2026 · 20:11 IST
Prepared by Kore.ai Competitive Intelligence

Bottom line: Competitors are aggressively pushing AI agent capabilities, with Salesforce and ServiceNow highlighting their platform integration and IBM focusing on a "control plane" approach. Kore.ai's ABL and proven analyst leadership remain key differentiators against these broad platform plays and emerging agent-focused vendors.

WHAT MATTERS THIS RUN

Three signals that matter

Salesforce Expands Agentforce to WhatsApp/SMS, Highlighting B2B Commerce

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-07-23) Salesforce launched a new B2B Commerce suite that embeds an AI buying agent directly into WhatsApp and SMS channels, aiming to streamline B2B purchasing journeys. MarketScale [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
This move reinforces Salesforce's strategy of embedding agentic AI within its core CRM and commerce workflows, creating a potential lock-in for existing customers. Kore.ai's provider-agnostic approach and deep integration capabilities across any CRM or commerce platform offer a compelling alternative for enterprises seeking flexibility.

ServiceNow CEO Emphasizes "Kill Switch" for AI Agents, Positioning for Control

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-07-23) ServiceNow CEO Bill McDermott stated that the company has a "kill switch" to stop rogue AI agents, positioning ServiceNow as a leader in bringing "AI discipline" to enterprise AI chaos. TechRadar [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
ServiceNow's focus on control and governance aligns with Kore.ai's ABL, which provides compile-time validation and deterministic execution. We can highlight our inherent "safety features" built into the platform, rather than as an add-on, contrasting with ServiceNow's emphasis on reactive "kill switches."

IBM Positions watsonx Orchestrate as a Multi-Vendor "Agentic Control Plane"

WHAT HAPPENED
(2026-07-23) IBM announced that its watsonx Orchestrate platform is being repositioned as a multi-vendor "agentic control plane," capable of orchestrating agents from various providers including Granite, Claude, GPT, and Mistral. [CX Today](#) [WHAT IT MEANS FOR KORE.AI](#)
IBM's strategy acknowledges the need for flexibility in model selection, a core tenet of Kore.ai's ABL. We can emphasize our established, provider-agnostic model tiering and routing capabilities, which offer a more mature and integrated "control plane" for enterprise CX than IBM's newer, multi-vendor orchestration approach.

AT A GLANCE

Signal priority table

Competitor	Move (dated)	Threat	Kore.ai counter
Salesforce	(2026-07-23) Embeds AI buying agent on WhatsApp/SMS for B2B Commerce - MarketScale	Med	Provider-agnostic integrations vs. platform lock-in
ServiceNow	(2026-07-23) CEO highlights "kill switch" for AI agents, touts AI discipline - TechRadar	Med	Built-in determinism and validation vs. reactive controls
IBM	(2026-07-23) Positions watsonx Orchestrate as a multi-vendor "agentic control plane" - CX Today	Low	Mature, integrated model routing vs. emerging orchestration
Genesys	(2026-07-22) Deepens strategic collaboration with AWS to accelerate global AI innovation - Business Wire	Low	Pure-play CX AI platform vs. CCaaS incumbent AI bolt-on
Sierra	(2026-07-23) Acquires agent startup 'Takeoff' to diversify its business - The Information	Low	Proven CX analyst leadership vs. emerging agent platform
Five9	(2026-07-21) Names New CTO, Sales Chief, and Strategy Executive - theaisoftwarereport.com	Low	Enterprise-grade platform vs. seat-model pressure
Glean	(2026-07-21) Partners with Glean to Accelerate Enterprise AI Adoption and Operational Transformation - EIN Presswire	Low	CX-native platform vs. employee-facing search

ON THE RADAR

Watch for

SO WHAT — DO THIS NOW

Recommended actions

- Highlight Kore.ai's **ABL's inherent governance and determinism** as a superior approach to reactive "kill switches" or complex orchestration layers.
- Position Kore.ai as the **flexible, provider-agnostic platform** of choice for enterprises wary of big-tech lock-in, especially concerning data and model dependencies.

EVIDENCE TRAIL

Sources

- (2026-07-21) Five9 Names New CTO, Sales Chief, and Strategy Executive - [theaisoftwarereport.com](#)
- (2026-07-21) GleekOps Partners with Glean to Accelerate Enterprise AI Adoption and Operational Transformation - [EIN Presswire](#)
- (2026-07-21) LTM partners with Glean to bring enterprise knowledge into agentic AI workflows - [varindia.com](#)
- (2026-07-22) Feazel Scaling Home Services with Agentforce - [Salesforce](#)
- (2026-07-22) Genesys Deepens Strategic Collaboration with AWS to Accelerate Global AI Innovation - [Business Wire](#)
- (2026-07-22) Alva's engineering college launches AI lab in collaboration with IBM Software Labs - [The Hindu](#)
- (2026-07-22) ServiceNow CEO defends the company's relevancy, touting a kill switch for rogue AI agents - [CNBC](#)
- (2026-07-22) The race to be an AI-first enterprise has begun, IBM plans for Asia Pacific to lead by 2030 - [Manila Bulletin](#)
- (2026-07-23) Experian accelerates AI-first experiences with ServiceNow AI Platform - [Business Wire](#)
- (2026-07-23) IBM Says AI Agents Need Real-Time Data to Deliver Value - [CX Today](#)
- (2026-07-23) IBM is rebranding around AI, trust and enterprise transformation as Arvind Krishna overhauls its go-to-market strategy - [Storyboard18](#)
- (2026-07-23) Salesforce Named a Leader in the 2026 Gartner® Magic Quadrant™ for Conversational AI Platforms - [Salesforce](#)
- (2026-07-23) Salesforce's new B2B Commerce suite puts an AI buying agent on WhatsApp and SMS - [MarketScale](#)
- (2026-07-23) Sierra Acquires Agent Startup 'Takeoff' to Diversify Its Business - [The Information](#)
- (2026-07-23) 'We have a kill switch that stops AI agents that go rogue': ServiceNow CEO Bill McDermott says his company can help firms go "from AI chaos to AI discipline" - [TechRadar](#)